

Laptop and IT Equipment Policy

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1. Purpose

This policy establishes rules for the allocation, use, security, and return of company-issued laptops and IT equipment.

2. Scope

Applies to all employees, interns, and contractors issued a TCS laptop, monitor, or other IT equipment.

3. Definitions

Asset Tag	A unique barcode/ID sticker used to track company IT equipment.
Endpoint Protection	Security software installed on all company laptops (antivirus, encryption, monitoring agent).

4. Laptop Allocation

Every employee is issued a standard company laptop upon joining, as coordinated during onboarding (see Onboarding Policy, TCS-HR-006). Standard configuration is a 14-inch laptop with 16GB RAM and 512GB SSD; employees in engineering or data science roles may request a higher-spec configuration (32GB RAM) with manager approval. Each laptop is registered under an Asset Tag linked to the employee's ID in the IT Asset Management system.

5. Acceptable Usage

Company laptops are provided primarily for business use. Limited personal use (e.g., checking personal email, general browsing) is permitted provided it does not interfere with work, consume excessive bandwidth, or violate the Cyber Security Policy (TCS-IT-002). Use of company laptops for illegal activity, accessing offensive content, or running unauthorized business ventures is strictly prohibited.

6. Device Security

All company laptops are pre-installed with endpoint protection software, full-disk encryption, and remote wipe capability. Employees must not disable, uninstall, or attempt to bypass any security software. Laptops must be locked (Windows+L / Cmd+Ctrl+Q) whenever unattended, even briefly, and must not be left unattended in public places such as cafes, airports, or client sites.

7. Password Requirements

Laptop login passwords must meet the complexity requirements described in the Password and Access Control Policy (TCS-IT-004): minimum 12 characters, including uppercase, lowercase, numbers, and special characters, changed every 90 days.

8. Software Installation

Employees **cannot install unauthorized or unlicensed software** on company laptops. All software must be requested and installed via the Software Center on the employee portal or approved directly by the IT Helpdesk. Installing pirated software, unauthorized VPN clients, or file-sharing/torrent applications is a serious violation of this policy and may result in disciplinary action under the Code of Conduct (TCS-HR-014). Development tools and IDEs required for specific roles are pre-approved and available in the Software Center.

9. Hardware Damage

If a company laptop is physically damaged (e.g., cracked screen, liquid spill, keyboard malfunction):

- 1 Immediately stop using the device if there is a safety risk (e.g., swelling battery).
- 2 Raise an IT Support ticket on the employee portal describing the damage, including photos if possible.
- 3 Deliver or courier the laptop to the nearest IT service desk within 3 working days.
- 4 IT will assess whether the device can be repaired or must be replaced.

The first instance of accidental damage per employee per rolling 24-month period is repaired at no cost. A second incident within the same period may incur a deduction of up to 25% of the repair cost from salary, unless caused by a manufacturing defect, as determined by IT.

10. Lost Laptop Procedure

If a company laptop is lost or stolen, the employee must, **within 24 hours**:

- 1 Report the loss immediately to the IT Helpdesk and Reporting Manager.
- 2 File a police complaint (FIR) if the laptop was stolen, and share a copy with IT.
- 3 IT will trigger a remote wipe of the device where possible and disable its access to company systems.

Failure to report a lost laptop within 24 hours may result in the employee bearing the full replacement cost. This is treated as a potential security incident and must also be reported per the Cyber Security Policy's Security Incident Reporting section (TCS-IT-002).

11. Device Replacement

Standard laptop refresh cycle is every 4 years, or earlier if the device becomes obsolete for the employee's role. Replacement requests outside the standard cycle require manager and IT approval, with justification (e.g., persistent performance issues confirmed by diagnostics).

12. Returning Equipment

All company equipment (laptop, charger, monitor, docking station, access cards) must be returned to the IT Helpdesk on or before the employee's last working day. Full and final settlement of dues will be withheld until all IT assets are returned in working condition, consistent with clearance procedures at exit.

13. Personal Usage Restrictions

Personal external storage devices (USB drives, external hard disks) may not be connected to company laptops without prior IT approval, per the Cyber Security Policy (TCS-IT-002). Employees must not use personal cloud storage accounts (e.g., personal Google Drive, Dropbox) to store or transfer company or client data.

14. Frequently Asked Questions

Q: What should I do if my company laptop is damaged?

A: Stop using it if unsafe, raise an IT Support ticket describing the damage, and deliver it to the IT service desk within 3 working days for assessment and repair.

Q: Can I install software on my company laptop?

A: Only software available through the Software Center or explicitly approved by the IT Helpdesk. Installing unauthorized or unlicensed software is not permitted.

Q: What happens if I lose my company laptop?

A: Report it to the IT Helpdesk and your manager within 24 hours, file a police complaint if stolen, and IT will remotely wipe the device and disable its system access.

Q: How do I return my laptop when I leave the company?

A: Return all IT assets to the IT Helpdesk on or before your last working day; final settlement is withheld until equipment is returned.

15. Contact Information

IT Helpdesk	it.support@tcs-internal.com Ext. 1200
IT Asset Management	assets.it@tcs-internal.com